



Unstoppable: The Power of Healing & Growth Workshop

Participant Evaluation Summary | Final Report

Presented to the Los Angeles County Department of Mental Health

Health Matters Clinic | 2025

Overview

Unstoppable: The Power of Healing & Growth was a five-module, healing-centered workshop rooted in the lived experiences of Black communities impacted by disability. The program aimed to reduce stigma, increase awareness, and empower participants to explore the intersections of mental health, race, and disability in a culturally affirming space.

Using a retrospective post-then-pre evaluation method, this report assesses shifts in knowledge, attitudes, and confidence. The goal was to measure the workshop's impact on participants' mental health literacy, self-efficacy, and community readiness—while honoring the emotional and cultural context in which these conversations took place.

Key Findings

Mental Health Perception & Knowledge (Before vs. After)

- **Comfort Discussing Mental Health in the Black Community:** Strongly Agree responses increased from 28% to 69%, reflecting a significant rise in participants' confidence and willingness to engage openly on mental health topics within the Black community.
- **Understanding Systemic Challenges:** Strongly Agree responses increased from 28% to 69%, reflecting greater awareness of how racism and systemic barriers impact mental health access.
- **Awareness of Community Resources:** Only 21% strongly agreed before the session; that number nearly tripled to 58% after.
- **Feeling Equipped to Support Others:** Strongly Agree responses more than doubled (22% → 53%), showing increased confidence in helping others.



- **Identifying Symptoms in Black Youth/Adults:** Strongly Agree jumped from 15% to 57%, indicating significant growth in mental health literacy.

Participant Reflections

What They Learned

Participants valued:

- Understanding types and symptoms of depression and anxiety
- Exploring cultural stigma, implicit bias, and intersectionality
- Gaining emotional validation and connection in a safe space
- Practical tools like mindfulness, self-compassion, and stress management

“Recognizing and challenging stigmas... creating supportive communities.”

“Understanding symptoms of major depression in Black women.”

How They Plan to Apply It

Attendees plan to:

- Incorporate self-care, journaling, and mindfulness
- Share resources, start peer support groups, and check in with others
- Advocate for mental health equity at work, school, and in policy

“Attend events. Run for Congress. Keep this on the top of my platform.”

“I’ll recommend therapy to loved ones without judgment.”

Requested Support & Resources

Participants asked for:

- Free/affordable therapy and more Black mental health professionals



- Support groups, workshops, resource lists, and faith-based initiatives
- Culturally rooted tools like sound baths, journaling spaces, and nontraditional healing
- Grants, gift cards, and structural investment in underserved communities

“We need mental health services for teachers, youth, and families.”

“More mental health professionals who look like us.”

Recommendations to LACDMH

- **Increase Funding for Community-Based Mental Health Services**

Participants expressed a clear need for expanded, culturally responsive mental health services, including more accessible therapy, group sessions, and outreach tailored to Black communities.

- **Expand Education and Awareness Campaigns**

Many participants highlighted the importance of ongoing education about mental health symptoms, systemic barriers, and self-care strategies. Continued workshops and public awareness initiatives can sustain and deepen this knowledge.

- **Develop and Support Peer Support and Safe Spaces**

Feedback emphasized the value of safe, judgment-free environments for sharing experiences. LACDMH should support the creation and maintenance of peer-led support groups and community healing spaces.

- **Improve Access to Mental Health Resources**

A common request was for practical tools, printed and digital resource lists, and increased availability of mental health professionals who understand cultural and disability intersections.

- **Address Systemic Barriers with Intersectional Approaches**

Participants gained awareness of systemic racism and disability-related barriers. LACDMH should prioritize intersectional frameworks in policy, training, and program design to dismantle these obstacles.



- **Support Advocacy and Leadership Development**

Encourage and fund initiatives that empower community members to become advocates, educators, and leaders in mental health equity and racial justice.

Conclusion

The *Unstoppable* workshop created a powerful space for learning, healing, and connection. Participants left with a deeper understanding of mental health, greater confidence to support themselves and others, and a strong desire to take action within their communities. The data shows clear growth in awareness, self-efficacy, and engagement—especially around systemic barriers, stigma, and the unique needs of Black individuals impacted by disability.

More than just a workshop, *Unstoppable* served as a listening session and catalyst for change. The feedback reveals a growing call for culturally responsive care, sustained mental health investment, and safe spaces for collective healing. These findings will continue to inform future programming and partnerships aimed at advancing health equity and community resilience.

.